

EMMA KOCHENDERFER

(650) 733-5802 • emmakochenderfer@gmail.com • <https://www.linkedin.com/in/emma-kochenderfer/> • <https://github.com/kochenderferc>
• <https://kochenderferc.github.io/portfolio/>

EDUCATION

Chapman University, Orange, California Spring 2028
Double major in Computer Science (B.S.) and Theatre (B.A.) **3.84/4.0**

- Student Scholar Ambassador (August 2025 - Present); Conference Chair for Society of Women Engineers (May 2025-Present); Fowler Engineering Circuit (September 2026-Present)
- Courses: Data Structures and Algorithms (C++), Data Visualization for Business (Tableau), Digital Logic Design, Discrete Mathematics
- Provost's List (Spring 2026, Fall 2025), Dean's List (Spring 2025)

EXPERIENCE

Navi AI, San Francisco (Remote/Hybrid) May 2026 - August 2026
Field Software Engineering Intern

- Shipped 10+ internal tools, including a checkride-readiness estimator and aviation/AI media monitor
- Designed and built an automated quality-monitoring system that classifies thousands of instructor evaluation ratings into 8 recurring failure modes with severity scoring, and flags regressions against a rolling baseline with scheduled alerts
- Prepared and executed flight test plans in collaboration with Sling Pilot Academy in Torrance, CA

Chapman University, Orange, California August 2025 - Present
Student Research Assistant

- Collaborating with USC in the Machine Learning and Assistive Technologies (MLAT) Lab to benchmark how motivational system prompts affect LLM performance
- Independent research project on pilot cognition and metacognition in General Aviation at the LUCID Lab, supporting human-factors studies of pilot decision-making

Pyro Spectaculars, California May 2024 - Present
Pyrotechnician

- Federal explosive possessor permit (ATF/DOJ); execute large-scale pyrotechnic displays at major Bay Area venues under strict safety and regulatory procedures

Pivotal, Palo Alto, California May 2025 - April 2026
Flight Test Engineering Intern, Engineering Associate

- Executed structural and safety flight tests on new eVTOL aircraft; performed EMI verification on radio systems and built a Python tool to scan aircraft data for interference; ran region-specific EMI assessments
- Authored new in-field emergency response procedure for flight test; developed firmware (C#, Python) for the in-field telemetry system used by test pilots

Stanford University, Stanford, California June 2023 - June 2025
Researcher

- Processed and clustered ~75 DMV autonomous vehicle crash records to surface recurring safety patterns (Python); built an aviation phraseology dictionary to ground an in-cockpit LLM assistant and improve interpretation accuracy

EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Pilot August 2021 - Present

- Certified student and remote pilot with 100+ hours; piloted a PA-28 from Florida to Belgium for Prepare2Go; passed FAA Private Pilot Written exam

Volunteer Work July 2021 - Present

- EAA Chapter 20 (July 2021-June 2024): build RV-12 aircraft
- Pilot Mental Health Campaign: volunteer to spread information on current legislation and research

COURSES AND SPECIALIZATIONS

Aviation Fatigue Training, Purdue University (2022); FAA Special Awareness Training for the Washington, DC Area (SFRA/FRZ) (2024); Google AI Essentials, Coursera (2024); Adult and Pediatric First Aid/CPR/AED, American Red Cross (2025); Social and Behavioral Research, CITI (2025); Biomedical Research, CITI (2025)

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

Junior Science and Humanities Symposium, Medicine/Health 2nd place (2023); AOPA You Can Fly High School Flight Training Scholarship (2023); AP Scholar Award (2024); Chapman University Travel Grant (Fall 2025, Spring 2026, Fall 2026); Arthur C. Flint Science Award (2026)